

the construction is available. A magic-user who constructs a tower will gain 1-6 apprentices of levels 1-3.

THIEVES

Thieves may advance up to 36th level. In addition to their normal thieving abilities, a thief who reaches 4th level can *read languages* (including simple codes, dead languages, treasure maps, and so on, but not magical writings) with an 80% chance of success. If the attempt to read a given piece of writing fails, the thief must gain at least one level before another attempt to read it is allowed. At 10th level, the thief gains the ability to *read magic-user or elf scrolls*. However, there is a 10% chance the spell will backfire, creating an unexpected result, due to the thief's imperfect understanding of magical writings. This ability only allows the thief to cast spells from existing magic scrolls.

Thieves may not build castles or strongholds like other characters. However, upon reaching 9th level (Master Thief), a thief may construct a **hideout** (a fortified house in a city, a cave network, or so forth). A thief who has constructed a **hideout** will attract 2-12 1st level thieves who have come to learn under a master. These will generally (though not always) be loyal and will *not* be replaced by others if they die or leave. At this point, a player character thief may want to consider setting up a Thieves' Guild (the details of this are left to the DM).

Levels Beyond Those Listed

Several character classes (cleric, fighter, magic-user and thief) are allowed to advance to 36th level.

FIGHTING ABILITY: The expanded "to hit" tables show that each character class improves in combat ability at different levels. Every 3 levels for fighters, 4 levels for clerics and thieves, and 5 levels for magic-users, the chance of hitting improves by 2. Therefore a 16th level fighter will hit AC 2 on a roll of 7 or better while a 19th level fighter will hit on a roll of 5 or better. The number needed to hit may never be less than 2.

Level Progression Beyond 14th

Cleric	+ 100,000 XP required per level + 1 hit point per level
Fighter	+ 120,000 XP required per level + 2 hit points per level
Magic-user	+ 150,000 XP required per level + 1 hit point per level
Thief	+ 120,000 XP required per level + 2 hit points per level

Each class obtains certain benefits at higher levels. The DM must decide whether to use these suggested abilities or wait until the D&D® Companion supplement is released which will detail levels up to 36 in more detail.

Fighters: As they reach higher levels, fighters will be able to strike more than once per round. A suggested increase is that for every 5 levels above 15th, the fighter gains another attack that round. No more than 4 attacks per round may be gained.

Clerics and magic-users: These classes will receive several higher level spells (7th level and above) and also the use of more spells of lower level. The DM should look at the spell tables in the text and try to balance the number and any new spells to fit well with those already given.

Thieves: It will be noted that thieves have high chances of success in their special abilities when conditions are favorable for that action. Thieves will therefore gain new abilities requiring greater skill and danger. These will include the ability to climb overhangs, upside down, ventriloquism, powers of distraction, and the ability to mimic voices.

It is important to note that these are only *suggestions*. Those players and DMs who wish to wait for the D&D® Companion supplement will be provided with exact information concerning these higher levels. This information may not always agree with the suggestions presented here and players may discover changes in their characters if they create their own rules for advancement.

